

VULNERABILITY ASSESSMENT REPORT

For: Future Interns - Cyber Security Task 2 (2026)

Analysis of 3 Real-World Phishing Email Examples

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INTRODUCTION

What is Phishing?

Phishing is when attackers send fake emails pretending to be from real companies like Netflix, banks, or delivery services. Their goal is to trick you into clicking malicious links or sharing passwords and credit card numbers.

Why is phishing dangerous?

- Approximately 91% of cyber attacks start with a phishing email
- One wrong click can lead to stolen money or data
- Attackers are getting better at making fake emails look real

How this report helps

This report analyzes 3 real phishing emails, shows you exactly what red flags to look for, and gives simple steps to stay safe.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

What we did

We analyzed 3 phishing email samples pretending to be from:

- Netflix (payment failure scam)
- Delivery Service (package tracking scam)
- Bank (security alert scam)

What We Found

All 3 emails were 100% PHISHING. Every single email contained:

- Fake sender domain (100%)
- Suspicious link (100%)
- Generic greeting like "Dear Customer" (100%)
- Urgency or fear tactic (100%)

Why This Matters

These emails are designed to trick regular people. Without training, many employees would click these links and potentially compromise company data or personal information.

Overall Risk Level: HIGH for all 3 emails

COMMON PHISHING RED FLAGS

Here are the 6 most common signs of a phishing email. We found ALL of these across our 3 samples.

Fake sender domain

What to check: The email address after the @ symbol.

Example: billing@netflix-account.com

Why it's fake: Real Netflix uses @netflix.com, not @netflix-account.com

Attackers register fake domains that look similar to real ones. Always check carefully.

Suspicious links

What to do: Hover your mouse over any link BEFORE clicking.

Example: <http://netflix.update-billing.xyz/secure>

Why it's fake: Real Netflix uses netflix.com, not .xyz domains

The .xyz domain is cheap and commonly used by attackers. Legitimate companies use .com, .org, or .net.

Generic greetings

What to check: Does the email use your real name?

Example: "Dear Customer" or "Dear User"

Why it's suspicious: Real companies know your name and usually use it

Attackers send thousands of emails and don't know your name, so they use generic greetings.

Urgency or fear tactics

What to check: Does the email say "immediately," "24 hours," or "account locked"?

Example: "Your account will be suspended"

Why it works: Attackers want you to act fast without thinking

Real companies give you time and don't threaten immediate account loss.

Poor grammar and spelling

What to check: Weird phrasing, typos, or awkward sentences.

Example from our bank email: "You're account may be burned"

Why it's wrong: Should be "Your account may be blocked"

Legitimate companies have professional writers and proofreaders.

Request for personal information

What to check: Does the email ask for password, credit card, or OTP?

Why it's a scam: Real companies NEVER ask for passwords via email

If an email asks you to "verify your account" or "update billing," it's almost always phishing.

DETAILED EMAIL ANALYSIS

EMAIL 1: Netflix payment failure scam

Phishing Netflix email

From: billing@netflix-account.com
Subject: Your Netflix payment failed

Dear Customer,

Your recent payment could not be processed.

You may repeat again or wait for a moment.....!!

Update your billing info:
<http://netflix.update-billing.xyz/secure>

Netflix Team

The Email:

From: billing@netflix-account.com

Subject: Your Netflix payment failed

Body: "Dear Customer, your payment could not be processed. Update your billing info:
<http://netflix.update-billing.xyz/secure>"

What Makes This Phishing?

- Fake Sender Domain
 - Fake: @netflix-account.com
 - Real Netflix uses: @netflix.com
 - The extra "-account" is a trick
- Generic Greeting
 - "Dear Customer" (not personal)
 - Real Netflix would use your name

- Suspicious Link
 - Link domain: netflix.update-billing.xyz
 - Real Netflix domain: netflix.com
 - .xyz domain is a major red flag
- Urgency Tactic
 - "Your payment could not be processed"
 - Creates pressure to act quickly

How the attack works?

Step 1: You receive email saying Netflix payment failed

Step 2: You click the link to "update billing info"

Step 3: Fake website looks exactly like Netflix login page

Step 4: You enter your email and password

Step 5: Attackers steal your credentials and access your account

How to stay safe

- Don't click links in payment failure emails
- Go directly to netflix.com in your browser
- Check your Netflix account directly if you're worried

Risk Classification: PHISHING (HIGH RISK)

EMAIL 2: Delivery package scam

Phishing Delivery Email

From: tracking@issued-delivery.net
Subject: Package delivery failed

Dear Customer,

Your package could not be delivered.

You may contact the support for more clarifications....!!!

Track your shipment:

<http://issued.tracking-info.xyz/track?id=837492>

Issued-Delivery Support

The Email:

From: tracking@issued-delivery.net

Subject: Package delivery failed

Body: "Dear Customer, your package could not be delivered. Track your shipment:
<http://issued.tracking-info.xyz/track?id=837492>"

What Makes This Phishing?

- Fake Sender Domain
 - Fake: @issued-delivery.net
 - No real delivery company uses this domain
 - Attackers create these domains daily
- Generic Greeting
 - "Dear Customer" (not personalized)
 - They don't know your name

- Suspicious Link
 - Link domain: issued.tracking-info.xyz
 - Uses .xyz domain (cheap and untrustworthy)
 - Contains "tracking-info" to look real
- Urgency Tactic
 - "Your package could not be delivered"
 - Makes you worry about missing package
- Poor Grammar
 - "issued-delivery Support" (typo in closing)
 - Professional companies don't have typos

How the attack works?

Step 1: You receive email about failed delivery

Step 2: You click link to "track your shipment"

Step 3: Fake website asks for address and payment to "release" package

Step 4: You enter credit card information

Step 5: Attackers steal your card details

How to stay safe

- If you're expecting a package, check the tracking number from the real company
- Don't click links in delivery notification emails
- Go directly to FedEx, UPS, or USPS website

Risk Classification: PHISHING (HIGH RISK)

EMAIL 3: Bank security alert scam

Phishing Bank Email

From: alerts@trust-security.com
Subject: Unusual activity detected

Dear Valued Customer,

Unusual login detected from unrecognized device.

Your account may be blocked.

Verify your account:

<http://trust.secure-verify.xyz/login>

Trust Bank

The Email:

From: alerts@trust-security.com

Subject: Unusual activity detected

Body: "Dear Valued Customer, unusual login detected from unrecognized device. Your account may be blocked. Verify your account: <http://trust.secure-verify.xyz/login>"

What Makes This Phishing?

- Fake Sender Domain
 - Fake: @trust-security.com
 - Real banks use their own domain like @chase.com or @bankofamerica.com
- Generic Greeting
 - "Dear Valued Customer" (still generic)
 - Real bank would say "Dear John Smith"

- Suspicious Link
 - Link domain: trust.secure-verify.xyz
 - .xyz domain = almost always phishing
 - Uses "secure-verify" to sound legitimate

- Fear Tactic
 - "Your account may be blocked"
 - Creates fear of losing account access

- Poor Grammar
 - "You're account may be burned" (should be "Your account may be blocked")
 - "Burned" is completely wrong — real banks don't use this language

How the attack works?

Step 1: You receive alert about "unusual activity"

Step 2: You panic and click "verify your account"

Step 3: Fake website looks like your bank login page

Step 4: You enter username and password

Step 5: Attackers steal your banking credentials and drain your account

How to stay safe

- Never click links in bank emails
- Always type your bank's website address manually
- Call your bank using the number on the back of your card if concerned

Risk Classification: PHISHING (HIGH RISK)

PREVENTION GUIDELINES FOR EMPLOYEES

There are some of simple rules to never get phished

Rule 1: Always check the sender

Before reading any email, look at the email address after the @ symbol.

- Real: @netflix.com, @amazon.com, @chase.com
- Fake: @netflix-security.com, @amazon-support.net

Rule 2: Hover before you click

Before clicking any link, hover your mouse over it. Look at the bottom left of your browser to see the real destination.

- If it doesn't match the company name, DON'T CLICK.

Rule 3: Never enter password from an email link

Real companies will NEVER ask you to enter your password by clicking an email link.

- If an email asks you to "verify your account" — it's a scam.

Rule 4: Look for red flags

Ask yourself these questions before acting on any email:

- Does it say "Dear Customer" instead of my name?
- Does it want me to act immediately?
- Are there spelling or grammar mistakes?
- Is it asking for personal information?

If you answer YES to any of these, it's probably phishing.

DO THE FOLLOWING

- Delete suspicious emails immediately
- Forward phishing emails to your IT department

- Type website addresses manually instead of clicking links
- Use a password manager (it won't fill on fake sites)

DON'T DO THE FOLLOWING

- Don't click links in urgent emails
- Don't download attachments from unknown senders
- Don't reply to suspicious emails
- Don't call phone numbers listed in suspicious emails

What to Do If You Suspect a Phishing Email

Step 1: Do NOT click anything

Step 2: Forward the email to IT or security team

Step 3: Delete the email from your inbox and trash

Step 4: If you clicked a link, change your password immediately

Step 5: Report it to help protect others

7. CONCLUSION

What We Learned

This report analyzed 3 real phishing email examples. All 3 were successfully identified as phishing based on clear red flags.

Key Statistics from Our Analysis

- About 100% contained fake sender domains
- About 100% contained suspicious .xyz links
- About 100% used generic greetings
- About 100% used urgency or fear tactics
- About 67% contained grammar or spelling errors

Why This Matters for Businesses

Phishing attacks are the #1 way hackers break into companies. One employee clicking one wrong link can lead to:

- Stolen customer data
- Financial loss
- Reputation damage
- Legal consequences

Final Recommendations

1. Train all employees on these 6 red flags
2. Run regular phishing simulation tests
3. Create a simple way for employees to report suspicious emails
4. Make security awareness part of new hire orientation

REMINDER: Attackers only need one person to click. Your awareness is the best defense.